“Something is fundamentally wrong with me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Struggling with anxiety, depression, trauma, or other conditions can lead us to see ourselves as defective. Shame and comparison to “normal” people harden into a core belief that something deep inside is broken.

What Scripture teaches

“I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made.” “For He knows our frame; He is mindful that we are dust” (Psalm 103:14). “The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit.” Jesus said, “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.” Struggling does not make you defective. We live in a fallen world with bodies and minds affected by it, and God’s love is not reduced by it. Help exists and healing is possible.

> *“For He knows our frame; He is mindful that we are dust”* (Psalm 103:14).

Also see

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

> “The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit” (Psalm 34:18).

> “Jesus answered, ‘It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.’” (Luke 5:31).

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds” (Psalm 147:3).

Common self-statements

- I am defective.
- Normal people do not feel this way.
- I was made wrong.
- Something is deeply broken in me.
- I do not belong with healthy people.
- I am the problem.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either normal or defective.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never be okay.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling broken and concluding that I am.
- Labeling: Calling myself defective.

Challenging questions

- What does “wrong with me” actually mean?
- Who taught me to see struggle as defect?
- Would I call a friend with the same struggle defective?
- What does God say about how I was formed?
- What help have I sought or could I seek?

- What strengths do I also have?

Truth summary

> I am fearfully and wonderfully made, and my struggles are not a verdict on my worth. God remembers how I am formed, loves me, and provides help. I can seek care without shame.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Therapy
- God, Creator
- Guilt/Shame

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Something is fundamentally wrong with me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Something is fundamentally wrong with me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does "wrong with me" actually mean?
- ☐ Who taught me to see struggle as defect?
- ☐ Would I call a friend with the same struggle defective?
- ☐ What does God say about how I was formed?
- ☐ What help have I sought or could I seek?
- ☐ What strengths do I also have?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ God remembers I am dust.
- ☐ The Lord is near to the brokenhearted.
- ☐ The sick need a doctor.
- ☐ Help is available.
- ☐ I am not defective.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 103:14
  "For He knows our frame; He is mindful that we are dust."
- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Not defective: Each week, note one strength and one step of care.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 103:14 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God remembers how I am formed and loves me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List your strengths. Write ten things you do well.
- [ ] Seek help. Talk to a doctor or counselor.
- [ ] Speak kindly. Replace "wrong with me" with "struggling with."
- [ ] Pray Psalm 103:14. Rest in God's understanding.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Something is fundamentally wrong with me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Not defective
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Something is fundamentally wrong with me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You know how I am formed. Remove my shame, give me help, and let me see myself as You do. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #22 · BRAIN CHEMISTRY AND MENTAL ILLNESS

"I'm broken and can't be fixed."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Years of struggle and failed attempts to feel better can convince us that we are beyond repair. We may stop seeking help or keep it at arm's length.

What Scripture teaches

"He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds." "A bruised reed He will not break, and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish" (Isaiah 42:3). "We have this treasure in jars of clay to show that this surpassingly great power is from God and not from us. We are hard pressed on all sides, but not crushed" (2 Corinthians 4:7–8). "He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion." Healing may be gradual and incomplete, but you are not beyond God's care or good treatment.

> *"A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish; He will faithfully bring forth justice"* (Isaiah 42:3).

Also see

> "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds" (Psalm 147:3).

> "Now we have this treasure in jars of clay to show that this surpassingly great power is from God and not from us" (2 Corinthians 4:7).

> "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus" (Philippians 1:6).

> "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit" (Psalm 34:18).

Common self-statements

- I am beyond repair.
- Nothing can fix me.
- I have tried everything.
- I am a lost cause.
- I will always be broken.
- Why keep trying?

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either fixed or hopeless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never heal.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling broken and concluding that I am beyond repair.
- Labeling: Calling myself broken.

Challenging questions

- What has helped, even a little?
- What have I not tried yet?

- Who could offer fresh perspective, such as a counselor, pastor, or doctor?
- What does God do with bruised reeds?
- What does “fixed” look like, and is “better” enough?
- What small step can I take now?

Truth summary

> God does not break a bruised reed. I may be hurt, but I am not beyond help. Healing can be gradual, and I can keep taking steps with His help and the help of others.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Therapy
- Suffering
- Grace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God’s care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ’s resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm broken and can't be fixed"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm broken and can't be fixed." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What has helped, even a little?
- ☐ What have I not tried yet?
- ☐ Who could offer fresh perspective, such as a counselor, pastor, or doctor?
- ☐ What does God do with bruised reeds?
- ☐ What does "fixed" look like, and is "better" enough?
- ☐ What small step can I take now?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God heals the brokenhearted.
- ☐ He will not break a bruised reed.
- ☐ I am a jar of clay holding treasure.
- ☐ God will complete His work in me.
- ☐ Improvement is possible.
- ☐ I am not beyond help.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Isaiah 42:3
  "A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish; He will faithfully bring forth justice."
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:7
  "Now we have this treasure in jars of clay to show that this surpassingly great power is from God and not from us."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Steps toward healing: Each week, note one thing that helped.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Isaiah 42:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord will not break a bruised reed.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List what helped. Write even small things.
- [ ] Try one new help. Counseling, support group, or doctor.
- [ ] Be patient. Healing takes time.
- [ ] Read Isaiah 42:3. Remember God's gentleness.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm broken and can't be fixed": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Steps toward healing
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm broken and can't be fixed.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel broken. Thank You that You do not break bruised reeds. Heal me gently, in Your time, and lead me to the help I need. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"I'll never be normal."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Comparison with peers and social ideas of normal produce shame, especially for those with ongoing conditions. Longing to be "normal" can turn into grief or anger.

What Scripture teaches

The psalmist says, "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made." God told Samuel, "Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart." Paul writes, "God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong" (1 Corinthians 1:27). Many of God's servants in Scripture were far from ordinary. God does not call us to a statistical average. He calls us to be His beloved children. A good life is still possible.

> *"But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong"* (1 Corinthians 1:27).

Also see

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'" (1 Samuel 16:7).

> "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me" (2 Corinthians 12:9).

> "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God" (Romans 12:2).

Common self-statements

- Everyone else is normal.
- I will always be different.
- I do not fit.
- Normal people have it easy.
- I will never be like them.
- I cannot live a regular life.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people are either normal or not.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never be okay.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling different and concluding that I am abnormal.
- Labeling: Calling myself abnormal.

Challenging questions

- What does "normal" mean to me, and where did I get that idea?

- Who do I know that is truly “normal”?
- What has my difference taught me?
- What does Scripture say about God choosing the weak and unusual?
- What parts of a good life are available to me?
- Who accepts me as I am?

Truth summary

> God does not measure me against a statistical average. He made me and loves me, and a good life is possible. My differences can be places where His grace shows.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Weakness
- God, Creator
- Worldly
- Grace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God’s loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ’s final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus’ love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'll never be normal"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll never be normal." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does "normal" mean to me, and where did I get that idea?
- ☐ Who do I know that is truly "normal"?
- ☐ What has my difference taught me?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God choosing the weak and unusual?
- ☐ What parts of a good life are available to me?
- ☐ Who accepts me as I am?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God sees my heart.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ God chose the weak things of the world.
- ☐ His power is perfected in weakness.
- ☐ Normal is not the goal.
- ☐ A good life is possible.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **1 Corinthians 1:27**
  "But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong."
- ☐ **Psalm 139:14**
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ **1 Samuel 16:7**
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Accepted as I am: Each week, note one way you were accepted or lived well.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Corinthians 1:27 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God chooses the weak things of the world.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Define a good life. Write what matters to you.
- [ ] Find your people. Join a support group or friends.
- [ ] Celebrate a strength. Name something your experience taught you.
- [ ] Memorize 1 Corinthians 1:27. Say it when you feel different.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll never be normal": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Accepted as I am
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll never be normal.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I long to be normal. Help me accept how You made me, find a good life, and show Your grace through my story. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“My feelings are facts.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Strong emotions feel like truth. When anxious or depressed, thoughts like “I am in danger” or “I am worthless” feel certain. Without distance, we act on feelings as though they were reality.

What Scripture teaches

“The heart is deceitful above all things and beyond cure” (Jeremiah 17:9), and Proverbs warns, “There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the way of death.” Paul says, “Be transformed by the renewing of your mind.” “We take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ” (2 Corinthians 10:5). Feelings are real and important data, but they are not always accurate reports. David talked to his own soul, asking why it was downcast and telling it to put its hope in God (Psalm 42:5). We can feel and still ask, “Is it true?”

> *“Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise Him for the salvation of His presence”* (Psalm 42:5).

Also see

> “We tear down arguments and every presumption set up against the knowledge of God; and we take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ” (2 Corinthians 10:5).

> “Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God” (Romans 12:2).

> “There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the way of death” (Proverbs 14:12).

> “Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable—if anything is excellent or praiseworthy—think on these things” (Philippians 4:8).

Common self-statements

- If I feel it, it must be true.
- I feel worthless, so I am.
- I feel doomed, so I am.
- My feelings never lie.
- Questioning them is denying them.
- My gut is always right.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing feelings are always true or always false.
- Fortune telling: Predicting based on how I feel.
- Emotional reasoning: Treating feelings as facts.
- Emotional reasoning: Calling a feeling a fact.

Challenging questions

- What exactly am I feeling, and what thought goes with it?
- What evidence supports and challenges that thought?

- Has a strong feeling been wrong before?
- What would I say if my soul were a friend?
- What does Scripture say about thoughts and the mind?
- Who can help me test my thoughts?

Truth summary

> My feelings are real, but they are not always accurate. I can name them, test the thoughts attached to them, and speak truth to my own soul, as David did.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Thinking, Unhealthy
- Thinking, Healthy
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Anxiety/Worry
- Wisdom

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Thinking, Healthy
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My feelings are facts"

✦ ✦ ✦

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Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My feelings are facts." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly am I feeling, and what thought goes with it?
- ☐ What evidence supports and challenges that thought?
- ☐ Has a strong feeling been wrong before?
- ☐ What would I say if my soul were a friend?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about thoughts and the mind?
- ☐ Who can help me test my thoughts?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Feelings are real, not always right.
- ☐ I can ask, "Is it true?"
- ☐ I can renew my mind.
- ☐ I can take thoughts captive.
- ☐ I can talk to my soul.
- ☐ Hope in God.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 42:5

  "Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise Him for the salvation of His presence."

- ☐ 2 Corinthians 10:5

  "We tear down arguments and every presumption set up against the knowledge of God; and we take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ."

- ☐ Romans 12:2

  "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Feeling and fact: Each day, write one feeling, the thought, and a truer thought.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 42:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can feel deeply and still ask whether it is true.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Thinking, Unhealthy" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Name the feeling. Write it plainly.
- ☐ Test the thought. Ask for evidence for and against.
- ☐ Speak to your soul. Say Psalm 42:5 aloud.
- ☐ Share. Talk through it with a counselor or friend.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My feelings are facts": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Feeling and fact
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My feelings are facts.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my feelings are strong. Help me notice them, test them, and hold fast to Your truth. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"I'm going crazy."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Racing thoughts, panic, intrusive images, flashbacks, or strange sensations can be frightening and make us fear losing our minds. Fear of "going crazy" often intensifies the very symptoms, and secrecy deepens it.

What Scripture teaches

God has not given us "a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control" (2 Timothy 1:7). "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul." "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You." "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you." Anxiety and distress are among the most common human experiences, and they are treatable. They do not mean you are losing your mind. Tell a doctor or counselor right away if symptoms are severe or frightening.

> *"For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control"* (2 Timothy 1:7).

Also see

> "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul" (Psalm 94:19).

> "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You" (Isaiah 26:3).

> "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you" (1 Peter 5:7).

> "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus" (Philippians 4:6–7).

Common self-statements

- I am losing my mind.
- I am going to snap.
- I cannot control my thoughts.
- Something terrible is happening in my head.
- I am out of control.
- If anyone knew they would lock me up.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either sane or going crazy.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will lose control.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling terrified and concluding that I am going crazy.
- Catastrophizing: Calling myself crazy.

Challenging questions

- What exactly am I experiencing?
- Has a doctor or counselor evaluated these symptoms?

- How often do these fears come true?
- What helps calm my body, like slow breathing or prayer?
- Who can I tell?
- What does Scripture say about God's gift of a sound mind?

Truth summary

> These experiences are frightening but common and treatable. God gives power, love, and self-control, and I can seek help right away. I am not alone.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anxiety/Worry
- Fear
- Peace
- Therapy
- Depression, Symptoms of

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm going crazy"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm going crazy." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly am I experiencing?
- ☐ Has a doctor or counselor evaluated these symptoms?
- ☐ How often do these fears come true?
- ☐ What helps calm my body, like slow breathing or prayer?
- ☐ Who can I tell?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God's gift of a sound mind?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God gives me power, love, and self-control.
- ☐ His consolation delights my soul.
- ☐ He keeps me in perfect peace.
- ☐ He cares for me.
- ☐ Help is available.
- ☐ I am not alone.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 2 Timothy 1:7
  "For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control."
- ☐ Psalm 94:19
  "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul."
- ☐ Isaiah 26:3
  "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

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  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
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  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Calm and supported: Each week, note one step you took for calm and one person you told.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, 2 Timothy 1:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God has given me power, love, and a sound mind.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
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6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Talk to a professional. See your doctor or a counselor soon.
- ☐ Slow your breathing. Breathe in for four, out for six.
- ☐ Tell someone safe. Do not hide it.
- ☐ If you feel unsafe, call or text 988 (U.S.). Call 911 in an emergency.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm going crazy": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Calm and supported
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Tue				
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After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm going crazy.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am afraid for my mind. Calm me, send help, and keep me in Your peace. Amen.

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